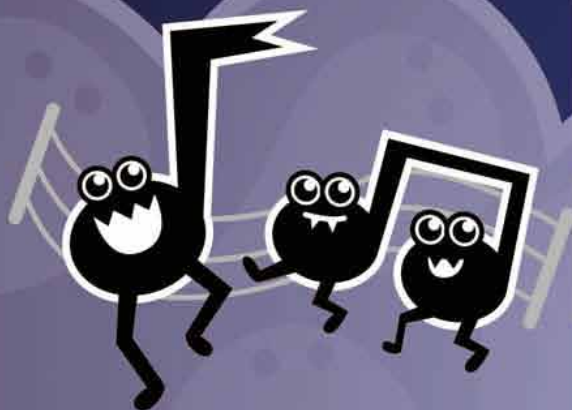




MIND MUSIC

Have you ever been bugged by a tune that you just cannot get out of your head? That's your auditory memory at work. Despite being deaf, celebrated German composer Ludwig van Beethoven (1770–1827) wrote great symphonies in his head without hearing a note of them played.

PICTURE THIS

Artists and other visually creative people find it a lot easier to think in pictures than in words. They are able to form strong mental images in their mind's eye, before making them come to life in the form of drawings, paintings, and sculptures.



IF THE SHOE FITS . . .

Making up games and dressing up as other people are important ways that young children learn about the world. The ability to imagine yourself in someone else's shoes (or inside someone else's head) and feel how they might feel is called empathy.



LIE BACK AND IMAGINE

Imagination is our path to change. Without it, we would be trapped in our present reality. But our environment is actually the end product of imagination. Many of the things that we now take for granted, such as electricity and air travel, were once a figment of someone else's imagination. Just imagine what tomorrow might bring . . .



CAN ANYONE HAVE A NEW IDEA?

While some people claim that all of the good ideas have been thought of, others keep using their imagination to exciting effect. For budding inventors, lateral (sideways) thinking helps. Swiss inventor George de Mestral (1907–1990) noticed that the burs he pulled off his dog's coat were covered in tiny hooks that had clung to the animal's fur. Why not make a fastener like that, he thought—and invented Velcro!

“IMAGINATION IS MORE IMPORTANT THAN KNOWLEDGE.”

Albert Einstein (1879–1955),
German physicist